



Jules Marchetti

VISITING CHEF

“Came to write a cookbook. Stayed for the drama.”



✦ FOR YOUR EYES ONLY ✦

OPTIONAL · JOINS AT 8

WHAT TO WEAR

A white chef's jacket or an apron over smart clothes, a neckerchief, and a wooden spoon to wave for emphasis.

At the table you are: passionate, generous and quick to take offense on behalf of a sauce.

How this booklet works



Before the party: read page 2 alone. It holds your story and your secret.



Starter served: open Round 1 on page 3 when the host calls it.



Main course served: unfold page 3 and open Round 2.



Dessert served: open Round 3 on page 4, then vote.

Printed single-sided, so later rounds can't show through.



THE EVENING

Autumn, the 1930s. Bartholomew “Barty” Thistle, retired jam magnate, has invited a few old friends to the Harvest Supper at Thistledown House. Before the soup was served, Barty took a glass of elderflower cordial in the study, sat down for a rest, and never woke up. Someone at this table knows why.

Never show this booklet to anyone. You may bend the truth about your secret, but never about the evidence.



You are innocent.

You did not harm Barty, and you want the truth to come out.

You are an optional character. If you are not in the game, nothing breaks.

Your story

You are a chef from a grand Brighton hotel, staying at Thistledown for the autumn to write a cookbook with Barty. You created a new recipe, Thistledown Harvest Jam, and Barty planned to sell it under the Thistle name without a word of credit to you.

YOUR SECRET

At four o'clock you and Barty quarreled in the kitchen about the recipe. You shouted, "You will regret this supper!" and Cook heard every word.

Where you were

- 4:00 Quarreled with Barty in the kitchen.
- 5:45 - 6:30 Setting the dining table and arranging the flowers. Harper kept you company until 6:10, then was on the hall telephone in plain sight through the open door.
- about 6:05 Heard the study door click shut across the hall, then footsteps going up the main stairs.
- 6:30 Sherry in the drawing room.

Your goal tonight

Clear your name and get credit for your jam. Keep the quarrel quiet until Round 2.

If someone asks you...

- "Did you cook tonight?" "I planned it. Cook cooked it. I set the table like a painting."
- "Did you touch the cordial?" "Cordial? I am a chef, not a gardener. Ask Quinn."
- "Where were you?" "In the dining room, with Harper in view through the door."

YOUR NOTES BEFORE THE PARTY

Jules Marchetti • Rounds 1 & 2

ONE ROUND AT A TIME



Round 1 • Starter

OPEN ONLY WHEN THE HOST CALLS IT

Read only when the Starter is served.

SHARE THIS

- I planned every course tonight, so tell me honestly what you think of the starter.
- From a quarter to six until the sherry I was in the dining room. Harper was with me, then on the hall telephone where I could see the whole time.

ASK

- **Harper:** “Will tonight’s supper appear in your column?”
- **Quinn:** “Who made the cordial in Barty’s glass?”

YOUR TASK

Describe the main course as if it were a love poem.



 FOLD OR CUT HERE · KEEP ROUND 2 HIDDEN UNTIL THE MAIN COURSE IS SERVED



Round 2 • Main Course

OPEN ONLY WHEN THE HOST CALLS IT

Read only when the Main Course is served.

SHARE THIS

- At four o'clock Barty and I quarreled about my jam recipe. I said, "You will regret this supper!" I meant the menu, I promise.
- At about five past six I heard the study door click shut across the hall, then footsteps going up the main stairs.

ASK

- **Sage:** “Are you staying the night upstairs?”
- **Avery:** “What did you see when you arrived?”

YOUR TASK

Ask each suspect for one word to describe Barty. Note them down.

NOTES · ROUNDS 1 AND 2

“MUST SHARE” lines are true and important. Say them during the round, in your own words.

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THEN VOTE

Round 3 · Dessert

OPEN ONLY WHEN THE HOST CALLS IT

Read only when the Dessert is served.

SHARE THIS

- The footsteps on the stairs at five past six were quick and light, like someone who did not want to be heard.
- Barty promised me credit for the jam in the cookbook. Now I will never know.

ASK

- **Rowan:** “Will you still publish our cookbook?”
- **Morgan:** “Who sleeps in the rooms at the top of the main stairs?”

YOUR TASK

Serve (or mime serving) dessert with a flourish and name the dish.

NOTES

SUSPECTS AT A GLANCE (PUBLIC INFORMATION)

#	NAME	ROLE	#	NAME	ROLE
10	Rowan Thistle	Heir to Thistledown House	14	Harper Vale	Food Critic
11	Ellis Fairweather	Family Doctor	15	Quinn Ashby	Head Gardener
12	Morgan Pike	Steward of Thistledown House	16	Avery Lark	Newspaper Reporter
13	Sage Whitlock	Family Solicitor	17	Jules Marchetti	Visiting Chef